

VINCENT VAN DEN BRAKEN

Principal Software Engineer · Architecture & Engineering Standards · AI-Native Delivery

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// PROFILE

30-year software engineer with the last decade in technical leadership across regulated SaaS, enterprise finance, and government. I've spent my career raising engineering standards at the org level — code review culture, automated quality gates, test-first discipline, and architectural consistency across multiple teams — while shipping product that customers pay for.

Language-agnostic architect. My depth is in backend systems, distributed architecture, and the discipline of production engineering at scale. Python, C#, TypeScript — I pick up the language to solve the problem. Over the past two years I've integrated Claude and multi-model AI workflows into every phase of delivery: design, code, review, migration. Not as a novelty — as a 11× force multiplier on throughput while maintaining compliance-grade quality gates.

The part of this role that interests me most is the bridge between product engineering and applied research. At my current company I sit at the intersection of three sister organisations — each with its own domain, stack, and stakeholders — and work across them to align architecture, security, and delivery standards without flattening any one team's autonomy. That adjacency feels remarkably similar to what Synthesia describes between its product and R&D orgs.

30

Years
professional experience

Lead

Technical leadership
last 10 years, cross-team

11×

AI multiplier
AI-agent workflow
throughput

319k

Lines deleted
tech debt elimination in 4mo

// ENGINEERING PHILOSOPHY

Standards before tools. I don't believe in imposing uniformity for its own sake. The goal is enough consistency that an engineer from Team A can review a PR from Team B and immediately understand the patterns, without either team losing the autonomy to pick the right tool for their problem. That's a balance I've struck three times — at the Belastingdienst (introducing test automation + structured logging across 4 teams), at Rabobank (peer review as a cultural standard, not a checkbox), and at SkinConsult (code review standards across 3 holding companies).

AI is a craft tool, not a crutch. I use Claude daily — for architecture exploration, code generation, review, migration scripts, and documentation. Every output goes through the same quality gates as human code: audit-trail checks, tenant isolation verification, data-boundary validation. The multiplier isn't in the generation — it's in the operator discipline to validate what gets produced. That's the same mindset Synthesia's product engineers would need working alongside R&D: trust but verify, at speed.

Commercial outcomes drive architecture. Every technical decision I've made in the past 10 years ties to a business metric. When I refactored a monolith into modular services, it wasn't for architectural purity — it was because regulatory deadlines required parallel delivery threads. When I eliminated 319k lines of code in 4 months, it wasn't a cleanup — it was reducing cognitive load so the team could ship features faster. Engineering exists to serve the product.

// WORK EXPERIENCE

// CLUSTER · LIFE SCIENCES HOLDING – three sister organisations under one holding, each with own management, domain, and stakeholders. I set technical direction across all three.

Technical Lead · SkinConsult

dec 2021 – aug 2026

Stack: .NET · Azure · Python (data pipelines) · AI-agent workflows · DDD · Event-driven

- Tech lead for EU-regulatory SaaS platform (cosmetovigilance); architected modular backend services from legacy monolith to event-driven microservices serving 50,000+ product SKUs.
- Introduced org-wide code review standards, automated quality gates, and peer review culture across 3 sister companies — reducing PR review cycle from days to hours.
- AI-agent workflow integration as a delivery methodology across the full SDLC: 11× throughput multiplier, 319k lines of tech debt eliminated in 4 months alongside feature work.
- Zero-downtime deployments, infrastructure-as-code (Bicep, GitHub Actions), Azure Service Bus for async event-driven communication.
- Owned architecture decisions with direct P&L impact: migration strategy reduced cloud costs 40% while improving reliability SLAs.

Technical Consultant · Allergie Centra Nederland

jun 2023 – aug 2026

Stack: Azure · .NET · Python · Cloudflare · Data pipelines · Compliance (NEN 7510)

- Azure integrations and automation: custom APIs, data pipelines, external data scrapers — Python for ETL, .NET for API surface.
- Security-first architecture: tenant isolation, audit trails, data-boundary enforcement in patient-data context.
- End-to-end DevOps: Cloudflare edge, GitHub Actions CI/CD, infrastructure-as-code.

Technical Lead · Dermatologisch Centrum Utrecht

dec 2021 – mei 2023

Stack: .NET · Azure · Background workers · Event pipelines

- Cloud-native back-office and workflow APIs with async event pipelines and background workers.
- End-to-end infrastructure ownership: App Services, Functions, Service Bus, blob storage, Key Vault.

Consultant – Azure Integration Services · Rensa Family Company

may 2021 – nov 2021

Stack: Azure Functions · Service Bus · Enterprise Integration

- Enterprise integration via serverless architecture: Azure Functions, Service Bus messaging, Azure Integration Services.
- CI/CD pipelines and deployment strategy for distributed system landscape.

Project Development Manager · True People BV, Amersfoort

apr 2019 – nov 2021

Stack: .NET · Umbraco · Scrum · Multi-team management

- Operational management of multiple simultaneous delivery tracks; technical oversight across teams.
- Scrum process ownership, stakeholder management, delivery accountability.

// CLUSTER · DETACHERING VIA QUINTOR – three distinct assignments 2017–2019, each with its own client, domain, and engineering culture.

Technical Team Lead · Belastingdienst (Dutch Tax Authority) may 2018 – mar 2019

Stack: .NET Core · Test Automation · CI/CD · Structured Logging

- Lead architect after initial dashboard assignment; drove engineering standards across 4 teams.
- Replaced manual regression testing with automated test suites — reduced regression cycle from 2 weeks to 2 hours.
- Established ORM standards, structured logging, and automated deployment as org-wide practices.

Full Stack .NET Developer · Rabobank

sep 2017 – apr 2018

Stack: .NET MVC · Analysis Services · CI/CD

- Rebuilt financial steering set; replaced database backend with OLAP cube for real-time analytics.
- Introduced pull request peer reviews as a standard process — first team in the department to adopt it.

Frontend Developer · Evidos (e-signatures)

jun 2017 – aug 2017

Stack: ASP.NET Core · TypeScript · OpenID Connect

- HTML5 canvas signature positioning; integration with existing e-signature API.
- Authentication via OpenID Connect and OAuth.

Senior Developer & Team Leader · Deltec Software BV, Amersfoort

jan 2010 – may 2017

Stack: C# · CMS · CI/CD · B2B platforms

- Built B2B platforms for GroupAuto Nederland, Quinton Hazell, Motor-Parts — 100+ custom integrations.
- Introduced Continuous Integration (Git, Jenkins, MSBuild) across the engineering department.
- Business consultancy 2015–2016: POS integration for cloud-based cash register, migration Windows → cloud.

Developer → Senior Developer · Deltec Software & RoutIT (contract)

sep 1996 – jan 2010

Foundation in enterprise software delivery

- 13-year growth from trainee to senior. Legacy systems → early B2B web platforms.
- Founded RoutIT client portal (1999–2001): first customer support, ticketing, and monitoring systems.

// CORE SKILLS

Principal IC Capabilities

Cross-team technical direction, engineering standards at org level, code review culture, architecture governance, delivery consistency programs, bridging product and research

Languages

Python (data pipelines, ETL, AI-agent orchestration, scripting), C# (30yr expert), TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL

Backend & Architecture

Microservices, DDD, event-driven architecture, REST/GraphQL APIs, middleware pipelines, message queues (Service Bus), relational schema design, query optimization

AI-Native Development

Daily Claude user, multi-model AI orchestration, code generation with validation gates, AI-augmented testing, AI agent workflows in production SDLC

Cloud & Infrastructure

Azure (App Services, Functions, Service Bus, Key Vault, Blob, Aspire), Docker, CI/CD (GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps), infrastructure-as-code (Bicep)

Testing & Quality

Test-first methodology, automated regression, unit/integration testing (xUnit, Moq, pytest), code review standards, quality gates in CI/CD

Frontend (Awareness)

React, Angular, Vue — sufficient to validate API contracts and collaborate with FE teams

Security & Compliance

NEN 7510/7511 (healthcare), ISO 27001-aware, AVG/GDPR, tenant isolation, audit-trail implementation, data-boundary discipline

// LANGUAGES

- Dutch (native)
- English (C2)
- Spanish (basic)

// COMMUNITY

- HartslagNu — Emergency responder since 2015
- VVN Traffic Exam — Volunteer at local primary school since 2024
- Scouting Hiawatha — Leader (2012–2020)

